framework' of politics.[83] The Bharatiya Shikshan Mandal, among the most prominent Sangh affiliates involved in deliberations on the NEP, hailed it as a 'new revolution'. It announced that 'almost 60%' of its suggestions had found a place in the NEP, including the renaming of the Ministry of Human Resource Development as Ministry of Education.[84]

The Sangh's exultation over NEP 2020 comes from a long history of battles over the design of Indian education. In the RSS's view, the Radhakrishnan Commission of 1948 and the Kothari Committee of 1964 had spoken of decolonising education, but no tangible measures had followed thereafter. From the 1960s onwards, the RSS saw the 'outsourcing of the education baton to the Communists in 1967, denigrating whatever is Bharatiya' as the 'crux of education'. It argued that this was essentially an 'imitation' strategy that led to a big gap between national needs and education outputs in the post-liberalisation period.[85] This is why the RSS focuses so much on education, its main goal being the introduction of what it sees as 'Indian knowledge treasures' in primary school.[86]

Figure 14.8: RSS-affiliated Outfits Pushed for and Welcomed NEP 2020